# Welcome to *Flipside.*

Flipside is a mixtape maker for the music you own. Pick a C60 or a C90, fill Side A and Side B, write the label by hand, and give it to someone. It runs on your phone or computer and plays from your Plex server. Powered by myStereo, from Own Your Media Club.




### THE SHORT VERSION

- **Open it:** `ownyourmedia.club/flipside/app`, then add it to your Home Screen.
- **Sign in to Plex,** or try the demo songs first.
- **Make a tape on your bench:** press **REC** on the deck. Record straight onto a C60 or C90, or plan it first with the Coach.
- **Send it to the rack** when it's done. File it in a drawer, play it on the deck or the TV, and send it to someone.
- **Tell BC what happened:** press **✎ NOTE** on the deck any time.

*Thank you.*

You're one of the first people to make a tape on Flipside, and that means a lot. It's an alpha, so things will break, words will be confusing, and some buttons will be too small. That's exactly what I need to hear about. Every note you send makes it better for the next person, and for the person you make a tape for.

*– BC*

## What's inside

1. Getting started · 2. The Cassette Deck · 3. Making a tape on your bench · 4. Planning with the Coach, and the label · 5. The tape rack, drawers and Rework · 6. TV Mode, sending and printing · 7. Analog Mode, computers and sync · 8. What to test · 9. Notes for BC, known limits and fixes

1 · GETTING STARTED

# Five minutes from nothing to a tape.

1. **Put it on your Home Screen. iPhone:** open `ownyourmedia.club/flipside/app` in Safari, tap Share, then Add to Home Screen. **Android:** open it in Chrome, tap ⋮, then Add to Home screen or Install app. On a computer, just open the link.

2. **Say hello.** The first time it opens, a welcome card on the deck walks you through it. See it again in Menu › Alpha › Welcome Screen.

3. **Sign in to Plex** from the welcome card, or Menu › Music Sources › Plex. No Plex handy? Choose the Demo Library and try everything with sample songs.

2 · THE CASSETTE DECK

# All buttons, no screens.

| | |
|---|---|
| `REC` | Opens your bench to make a new tape (page 3). |
| `SEND MIXTAPE` | Sends the tape that's in the deck to a friend (page 6). |
| `PLAY/PAUSE` | Plays or pauses. The reels turn, and the tape on each reel grows and shrinks as the side plays. |
| `STOP/EJECT` | Stops the tape. Press again to open the door to your tape rack. |
| `REW` `FF` | Tap to jump back or ahead; hold to wind, with the sound of the tape. |
| `FLIP` | Turns the tape over. At the end of Side A it glows gold and waits for you. Side B never starts on its own unless you turn on Auto Reverse in Settings. |
| `⏮ RESTART` | Back to the start of the side. Tapes otherwise pick up right where you left off. |
| `▤ TAPE RACK` | In the top corner of the tape window: your rack, while the tape keeps playing. |
| ☰ SONGS | The track list. Tapes play in order, so the list is for reading. Tap a song on your own tape to add a note. |
| **The readout** | The counter, which side is playing, the tape length, and the song that's on. |
| **The lamp** | **PLEX**: streaming. **ANALOG**: playing from your phone. **NOT DUBBED**: offline, and this tape isn't on the phone. |
| `✎ NOTE` · **Menu** | NOTE writes BC a note. Menu turns the player over to the menu side. Sideways, a TV key opens TV Mode. |

**Make it yours:** Menu › Settings › Deck Color. The new **Club Colors** case is the default; the Sport line, Retro and Editions are all there too.

# When a side is full, it's full.

Your **bench** is where tapes get made. Open it with **REC** on the deck or Menu › **Workbench**. New tapes wait here, **On the Bench**, until you send them to the rack, so nothing half-done shows up in your rack. Upright on a phone, the bench has four tabs along the top: **Songs · Label · Plan · Tape**. Sideways or on a computer, your library, the crate and both sides sit side by side.

1. Press **+ New Tape** and write the label. Choose **C60** (30 minutes a side) or **C90** (45 a side) to record straight away, or **plan it first with the Coach** (page 4).

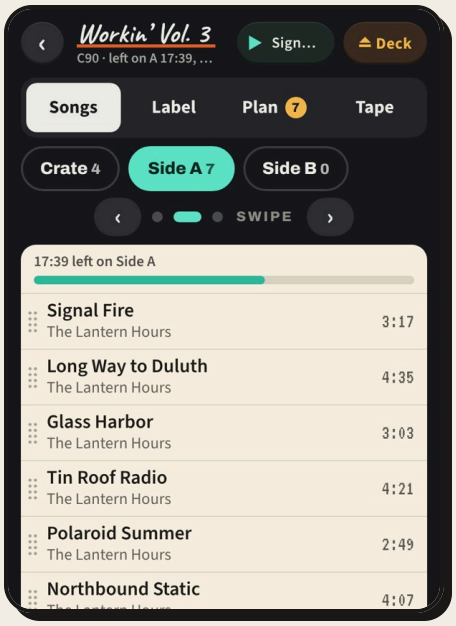
2. **Add songs** from your **Library**, **Don't Own** (a song you don't have yet, with buy links) or your **Wishlist**. On Songs, swipe between Crate, Side A and Side B. Each side shows the time left.

3. Tap a song for quick buttons: → **Side A**, → **Side B**, ▶ **Play**, **+ Why** and **✕ Off**. Or press and hold to drag it. Unsure about a song? Park it in the **Crate**.

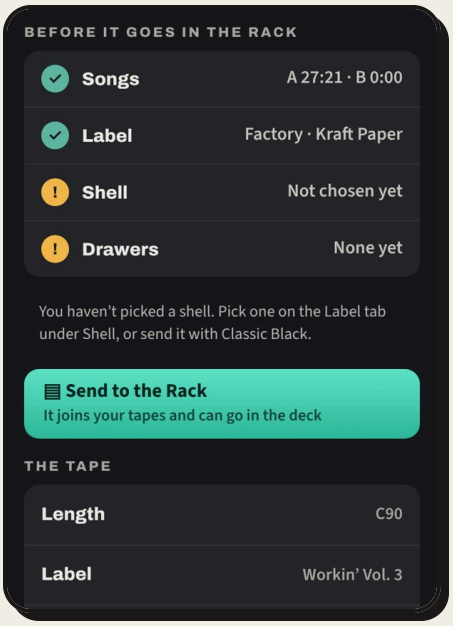
4. **Send it to the rack** NEW When it's done, open the **Tape** tab. A quick checklist shows the songs, the label, the shell and the drawers. Press ▤ **Send to the Rack** and it joins your tapes, ready for the deck.




Your bench: works in progress




Songs: Crate · Side A · Side B




Tape: the checklist, then send

# Plan before you press record.

A great tape is planned before it's recorded. **+ New Tape › Need help planning?** starts a plan instead of a tape. Plans wait on your bench under **Planning**, with no time limit, and the **Plan** tab teaches the craft as you go.

### Story Arc

Pick a shape: the Classic Arc, Road Trip, For a Crush, Party, Heartbreak, or Bright Side, Late Side. Or build your own beats. Each beat explains its job ("Opener: say hello").

### The Crate and the Running Order

The crate is the maybe pile: grab anything that might fit. Then move the keepers into the **Running Order**, under the beat where they belong.

### Hold a Spot · Why It's Here

Hold room for "something slow, about 4 minutes" before you know the song. Add a note to any song about why it made the tape.

### The Mixtape Coach

Gentle notes on the rules of thumb: an artist twice in a row, a long opener, the song before the flip. Press Got It, or turn the Coach off in Settings.

The plan always shows whether the order fits a C60 or a C90. When it's right, press ● **Record It**: the running order becomes the tape and it stays on your bench, ready for a last look and Send to the Rack. New to this? Menu › **The Art of the Mixtape**.

## Dress it up: the Label tab




The tape turns over to show its label. The choices come in two groups:

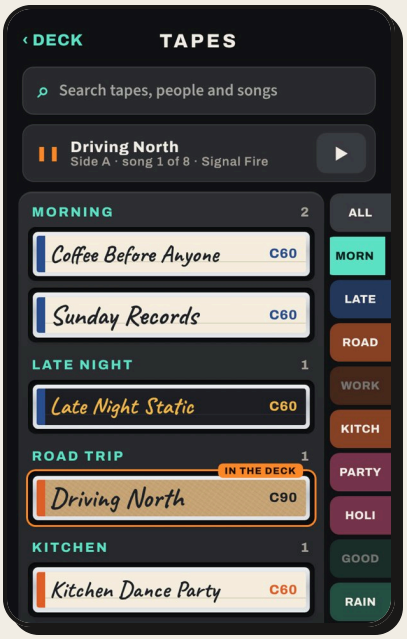
- **One tap: ✦ Surprise Me** picks for you. **Themes** set the whole look for a kind of music, from Rock and Jazz to Film Score and Soundtrack, and each one says what it sets. **Editions** match the special-edition decks.
- **Or pick each part: Design** (Classic, Factory, Handmade, Metal or Flipside Flat), **Paper**, **Pen**, **Ink** and **Shell**.
- **Start Over** goes back to plain.

The color band across the top of a tape tells you its drawer group (page 5), so it isn't on this list.

# A place for every tape.

STOP/EJECT twice, or ▤ TAPE RACK, opens your **tape rack**: every finished tape on its spine, grouped by drawer, newest first. What's in the deck shows at the top with a play/pause.

- **Drawers:** Morning, Late Night, Road Trip, Workout, Kitchen, Party, Holiday, Feel Good, Rainy Day and your own. The **tabs** down the right edge jump to one. **+** makes a new drawer; press and hold a tab to rename it or take it out.
- **The color band** on a tape is its drawer group: blue for Time of Day, orange for Activity, pink for Event, teal for Mood, purple for drawers you made, gray for not filed yet.
- **Lift a tape** by tapping it: it comes up big with its songs. Swipe for the next one. **LOAD TAPE** puts it in the deck; if another tape is playing, **SWAP IN THIS TAPE** stops that one and keeps its place.
- **The search bar** at the top finds tapes, who they're for and the songs on them.




The rack, filed by drawer




A lifted tape

## Under a lifted tape

| | |
|---|---|
| ASSIGN | Files it in as many drawers as you like. |
| SEND | Sends it to a friend (page 6). |
| DUB NEW | Saves its songs to your phone. Shows only while some songs aren't saved yet. |
| REWORK NEW | Takes the tape off the rack (and out of the deck) and back to your bench under **Rework**, drawers, notes and all. Change what you like, then Send to the Rack again. |

## Why It's Here

A line about why a song is on the tape: "the song we played on repeat driving up to Duluth." Write one from the deck's **SONGS** list (tap the song), with **+ Why** on the bench, or **+ NOTE** in TV Mode. Notes travel with the tape when you send it.

# Play it big. Give it away.

**TV Mode** is made for Screen Mirroring to a TV (on iPhone: Control Center › Screen Mirroring › your Apple TV). Open it from Menu › TV Mode, or the TV key on the deck sideways. Your tape sits on a shelf with the song, a counter, meters, Up Next and the song's Why It's Here note. It opens in the **Club** look; ◐ LOOK tries others and ≋ VIZ changes the meters. Tap anywhere for the tape keys; they fade so the TV stays clean.



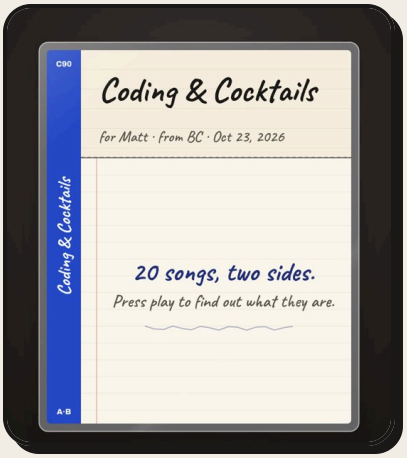

TV Mode, Club look

## Send a tape

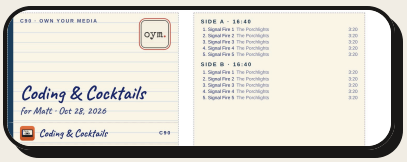
1. Load a tape and press **SEND MIXTAPE**, or **SEND** on a lifted tape.

2. **Song List: Surprise** keeps the songs secret until they've heard the whole tape. **Shown** writes every song on the card.

3. Pick a person on your Plex server (share your music library with them first), or Someone Else for a link. Your share sheet opens with a picture of the tape.




The card they get (Surprise)




## When someone sends you one

Tap the link and choose **Add It to My Tapes**. On a surprise tape, only the playing song is written on it until you've heard both sides. Their notes come along.

## Print the J-card

On the bench's **Tape** tab (once it's in the rack), **Print the J-Card** makes a paper insert for a real cassette case. Print at 100%, cut on the dashed line, fold on the dotted lines.

7 · ANALOG MODE, COMPUTERS AND SYNC

# Flipside, anywhere.

Menu › Settings › **Analog Mode**. With it on, every tape lives on your phone and plays with no signal: on a plane, up north, in the basement. The lamp on the deck says **ANALOG** when it's playing from the phone.

- **Recording really records:** each song you add is copied onto the phone. Tapes sent to you dub when you add them; **DUB** on a lifted tape saves one now.
- **Dub on Wi-Fi.** A full C90 is about 90 MB at Space Saver and 220 MB at High.
- Add Flipside to your Home Screen first, so your phone keeps the tapes.

**On a computer,** open the link and choose **Switch to Desktop Mode**. The deck fills the window, the rack has the drawers along the top, and the bench lays everything side by side so you can drag songs with the mouse.

### Everything follows you NEW

Sign in to the same Plex server on your phone and computer and your tapes, drawers, Wishlist, bench tapes and plans show up on both. Each tape is saved to Plex as a playlist. Works in progress have a ✎ in front of the name, so you can tell them apart in Plexamp. Change different things on two devices and both changes stick. Two Flipside windows open on one computer won't overwrite each other either.

8 · WHAT TO TEST

# Here's what I most want to hear about.

**Make a tape**
Fill a C60 on your bench and send it to the rack. Did the sides fill the way you expected? Did the checklist help?

**Rework one**
Lift a tape, press REWORK, change something and send it back. Did its drawers and notes come along?

**Screen locked**
Lock your phone and let a tape play across a few songs. Does it keep going? If it stops, is Play ready on the lock screen?

**Two devices**
File a tape in a drawer on your phone, then look on your computer. Plan a tape on one: does it show up on the other?

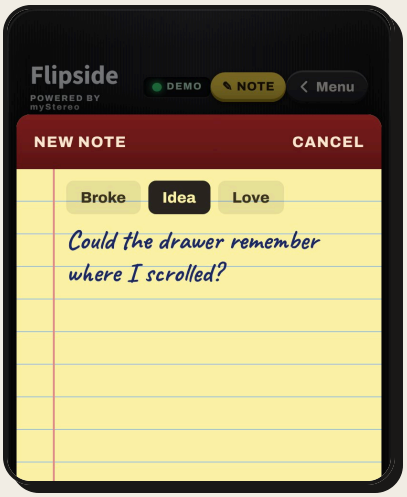
**Send a surprise**
Did the picture and link come through? Did the songs stay hidden on their end, and did your notes show up?

**Your phone**
Upright and sideways, big phone or small: anything cut off, too small or hard to tap? TV Mode from the couch?

# Notes, known limits and quick fixes.

Press ✎ NOTE on the deck any time something breaks, gives you an idea or makes you smile. Pick **Broke**, **Idea** or **Love**, write a line, and press **SEND NOW**, or save it for later. Each note is stamped with where you were and what was playing. Menu › Alpha › **Notepad** › **Send All to BC** puts every saved note in one email. No mail app? Copy them, or write to `bc@runawayanchor.com`.

Menu › Alpha also has **What to Test**, **What's New**, the **Quick Start Guide**, **Copy Playback Log** and **Restore Sketches & Tapes**.




## Known limits in this alpha

- Your friend hears your tape from your server, so you need to share your Plex music library with them first.
- Works in progress show up in Plexamp as playlists with a ✎. Leave them be; Flipside keeps them tidy.
- iPhones can still refuse to start the next song with the screen locked. If a tape stops, press Play on the lock screen.

## Quick fixes

| | |
|---|---|
| **First PLAY is silent** | Phones only start sound after a tap. Press PLAY again; check the volume and the ring switch. |
| **Unlocking opens myStereo** | Close myStereo in the app switcher while you're listening to Flipside, so the lock screen only has one player. |
| **Can't reach Plex** | Make sure your server is on with Remote Access turned on, then Menu › Music Sources › Plex › Reconnect. |
| **Lamp says NOT DUBBED** | You're offline and this tape isn't on the phone. Turn on Analog Mode, or press DUB, while you have Wi-Fi. |
| **Tape missing elsewhere** | Press Sync with Plex on your bench on both devices, signed in to the same server. |
| **New tape not in the rack** | It's still on your bench. Open the Tape tab and press Send to the Rack. |
| **Friend can't play a tape** | Share your Plex music library with them, then send it again. |

App: `ownyourmedia.club/flipside/app` · User's Guide: Menu › Settings › User's Guide · The Art of the Mixtape: Menu › The Art of the Mixtape

*Who are you making a tape for?*

Thanks again for being here. Now go make someone a mixtape.